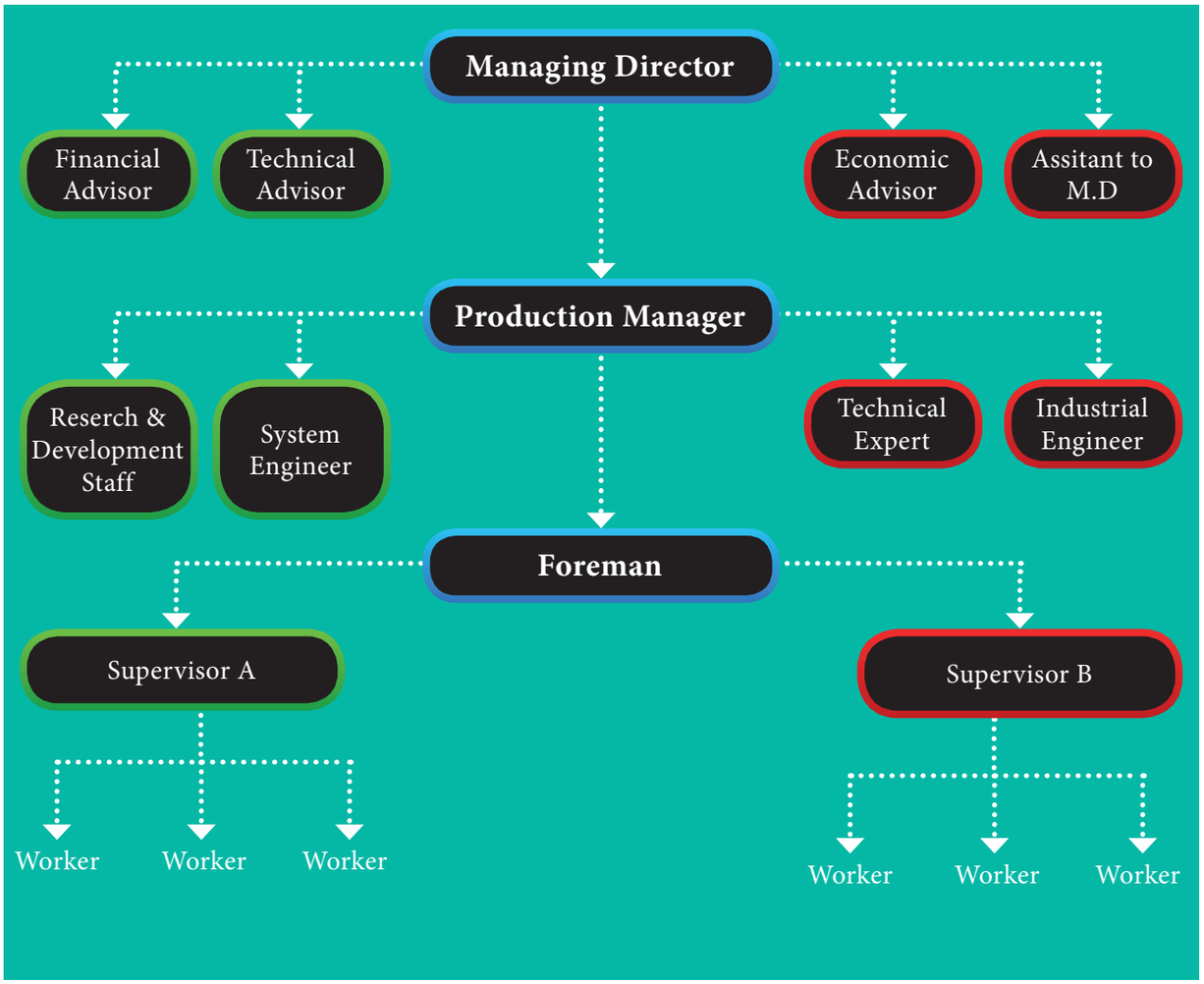


Figure 3.6 Line and Staff Organisation

Line and staff functions frequently overlap. Most staff executives may also simultaneously be line executives. For example, when the chief accounts officer gives expert advice to the chief line officer in respect of tax and accounting matters, he acts as a staff officer. When he supervises and controls the work of subordinates in his own department, he performs the functions of a line executive. When he directs the executives at different levels to follow certain specific accounting procedures in their respective departments, he assumes the role of a functional executive.

For eg: In the armed forces, the roles of line and staff agencies are clearly demarcated. The line part of the organisation does the front line fighting while the staff plays the supporting role (in the supply of information, logistics and so on). However, the staff managers are also trained to handle the front line roles in case of an emergency in the front-line battle front.

Merits of Line and Staff Organisation

- **Expert advice:** Line executives and through them the enterprise as a whole, benefit a great deal from the expert advice and guidance provided by the staff officers.
- **Relief to line executives:** Staff executives carry on detailed analysis of each important managerial activity. Hence line executives do not have to

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